ACI Media Dashboard: Deep Research

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Summary

ACI can build one dashboard that joins Plan, Spend, Performance, Digital Data, Competitor Tracking and Billing. No tool I found does all six for a brand owner in Bangladesh.

Five findings:

1. **The data exists, but it is scattered.** ACI's media data sits in 54 separate files. *Example: July to October 2026 spend is 129.96M BDT in one table, but the business table adds up to 130.66M.*
2. **The closest tool is built for big agencies.** Mediaocean Prisma joins planning, buying, billing and reporting, but it has enterprise pricing.
3. **Marketing dashboards are strong on goals and alerts.** Databox, Supermetrics and Whatagraph are built around digital data, not TV, Print and OOH.
4. **Competitor social data is limited.** YouTube is easy to pull. Meta commercial ads in Bangladesh can only be viewed by hand. TikTok has no fitting official route.
5. **Billing tools show a risk to avoid.** When payments happen outside the tool, the aging report goes out of sync. ACI has the same risk with Excel uploads and manual "paid" clicks.

All money in this document is in million BDT unless stated. Facts about outside tools come from vendor and review pages found by search (see Sources).

Agreed decisions

These decisions were settled in the discussion and confirmed. They are the base for UX research.

Area	Decision
Purpose	One dashboard for ACI's media work. It can become a product for other companies later.

Area	Decision
Scope	All 6 components stay in: Plan, Spend, Performance, Digital Data, Competitor Tracking, Billing. UX research will mark each as "must have" or "later".
Type of tool	A working tool, not view only. Users add plans, edit budgets and mark bills as paid.
Roles	Super Admin sees everything, sends reminders and approves budget changes. Management gets a summary and approvals. Finance handles bills and budgets. Planner handles plans only. Each role sees only its own area. Every edit goes into a history log.
Goals	No brand goes over its monthly budget. All unpaid bills in one click. See which channel gave the best reach.
Reach number	Cost per 1,000 people reached as the shared number, with the native TV and Digital numbers shown underneath.
Data in	Excel upload, manual entry and live links. Manual edits win over uploads. Every upload is saved as a version. Mismatches are flagged for a person to check.
VAT	Costs show with VAT.
Competitor data	YouTube pulled automatically. Meta ads logged by hand each month. TV, Print and Radio files uploaded by someone inside ACI. TikTok is on hold until a legal check.
Rivals tracked	Three rivals each for Savlon Soap, Freedom Sanitary Napkin and ACI Pure Salt. Salt has digital data only for now.
Alerts	Bills turn yellow at 15 days and red at 30 days. Budgets turn orange at 90% and red at 100%. Alerts show in the dashboard and by email. ACI can change these numbers.

Area	Decision
Devices	Desktop: full editing, uploads and deep charts. Mobile: summary, alerts, approvals and "Remind".

What ACI's data shows

ACI's 54 files already hold all six components, but each lives in its own file and its own format. The dashboard's first job is to join them.

The six components in the files

Component	Files	What it holds	Example
Plan	4 monthly Activity Calendars (Jul to Oct 2026)	Campaign calendar with cost by TV, Press, Digital and OOH	October plan: TV 28.60M, Press 0.71M, OOH 1.92M
Spend	CB Media Spent Report, Channel Cost, Agency Wise Cost	Spend by brand, month, media, TV channel and agency	Jul to Oct 2026 total: 129.96M. ATN News TV: 4.43M
Performance	6 brand dashboards (Savlon Soap, Septex, Hand Wash, Antiseptic Liquid, Baby Soft, Savlon Baby Wipes)	GRP, share of voice, share of spend and reach, brand against rivals	Septex Antiseptic Bar: about 2.4M spend in the first month shown
Digital Data	Toiletries, Hygiene and Salt digital files	Meta, YouTube and TikTok metrics: reach, impressions, cost per view, engagement	Toiletries Meta sheet has 159 rows
Competitor Tracking	36 July 2025 reports (12 Print, 6 Radio, 18 TV)	What ads ran by category, with spots and cost	Soap print report: Amar Desh, 160,000 BDT

Component	Files	What it holds	Example
Billing	Dashboard Media master (2,956 rows, 2021 to 2026) and Media Billing Statement	PO, bill amount, VAT and payment status	Statuses: Payment Done, Cheque in Hand, Finance/Audit, Bill Error, Cheque in Counter

Spend so far (July to October 2026, million BDT, with VAT)

Business	TV	Digital	Press	OOH	Total
Toiletries	50.01	22.41	0	2.15	74.57
Hygiene	15.04	11.09	3.43	5.29	34.85
Salt	8.50	3.16	0.70	2.48	14.84
Electrolyte	6.40	0	0	0	6.40
All	79.95	36.66	4.13	9.92	130.66

By month the grand total is 29.04M in July, 18.65M in August, 42.94M in September and 39.33M in October. TV is 61% of the table total. The three biggest brands are Savlon Soap (25.07M), Freedom Sanitary Napkin (19.29M) and ACI Pure Salt (14.84M).

Data problems the dashboard must handle

Problem	What I found	What the dashboard needs
Totals do not match	The business table adds to 130.66M. The grand total says 129.96M. The gap is 0.70M, the same as the Hygiene gap (34.85M against 34.15M).	An automatic check that flags totals that disagree
A duplicate dashboard	The Baby Soft and Savlon Baby Wipes dashboards are the same file (identical content, brand Baby Soft, period 2024 to 2025).	A check for duplicate uploads. Baby Wipes performance data is missing.
Agency file is incomplete	It covers July and August only.	A "data missing" state for September and October

Problem	What I found	What the dashboard needs
VAT is unconfirmed for some months	The spend report matches the agency "with VAT" figures in July and August. Example: Digital in July is 9.597M in both. September, October and OOH could not be checked.	One VAT setting per source, shown on every number
Competitor files are old	All 36 are dated July 2025. 35 were last saved under one person's name.	A "last updated" date on every competitor chart and a named owner
Unfair year comparison	The report shows spend down 67% (129.96M against 388.77M), but compares 4 months with 12.	Compare the same months only
Empty brands	Many brands show zero spend, such as Savlon Antiseptic Cream and ACI Pure Honey.	A clear empty state, not a blank chart

Media planning and billing tools

Mediaocean Prisma is the closest tool to ACI's idea, but it is built for large agencies and sold at enterprise level.

Tool	Built for	What it covers	Price signal
Mediaocean Prisma	Large agencies and big in-house teams	Planning, buying, billing and reporting in one place, across TV, digital, print, OOH and radio	Enterprise pricing (directory listing)
Bionic	Independent agency planners	Media planning and flowcharts	Described as cheaper and easier to adopt than Mediaocean

What Prisma does well

- **One system from plan to bill.** PPC Land reports that Prisma is a system of record for media management and finance, used by more than 100,000 people. Its new Prisma Direct product links ordering, campaign analytics, billing and reconciliation in one flow.
- **It replaces the same mess ACI has.** The same article says direct TV deals still run on spreadsheets, PDFs and re-typed orders. That is close to ACI's 54 separate Excel files.
- **Users like the layout.** A G2 reviewer says teams enter their digital, print and TV or radio campaigns with budget and timeline in one place. Other G2 reviews praise a clear, easy-to-navigate interface.

Where it does not fit ACI

- **Size and price.** It is built for agency networks and enterprise budgets. A brand team inside ACI does not need ordering and trafficking with global publishers.
- **Local fit is unproven.** The partners named in the news are US platforms such as Disney and Microsoft Advertising. I found no mention of Bangladeshi TV channels, newspapers or GRP data. I did not test this.
- **No competitor view and no mobile approvals** in the pages I read.

What ACI should take from it

- Keep Plan, Spend and Billing in one system so a number is typed once.
- Match what was planned, what was spent and what was billed. *Example: October plan says TV 28.60M. The dashboard shows the bill total beside it and flags a gap.*
- Use a calm, clear layout. Reviewers praise ease of navigation more than any single feature.

Marketing analytics and dashboard tools

These tools show the best pattern for ACI's home page: set a goal, show progress, send an alert. They are built around digital data.

The tools fall into three types: data connectors, dashboard builders and full platforms for agencies.

Tool	Type	Strength	Price signal
Supermetrics	Data connector	Sends data to Looker Studio, Google Sheets, BigQuery, Power BI and Excel	Starts lower than Databox's paid plans
Funnel	Data connector	Clean multi-channel data pipeline for larger organizations	Not checked
Looker Studio	Dashboard builder	Google's free reporting tool, best for Google-centred data	Free
Databox	Dashboard builder	Live KPI dashboards with goals, scorecards, alerts and Slack or email digests	Free plan with limits
Whatagraph	Agency platform	Polished reports with built-in dashboards	From $249 a month
AgencyAnalytics	Agency platform	Reports for agencies that bill clients	From $20 a month per client (annual plan)

What to copy

- **The "are we on track?" view.** Databox is strongest here, with goals and scorecards. *Example: a card says "Savlon Soap, October: 92% of budget used" and turns orange.*
- **Alerts that reach people.** Databox sends an alert when a number goes above or below a target. ACI's alert rules (90% orange, 100% red) follow the same idea.
- **Ready-made templates.** Databox's template library lets teams start fast. ACI can offer a starter layout for each role.
- **Email digests.** A weekly email with the three numbers that matter suits managers who rarely log in.

What they lack for ACI

- The pages I read describe sources such as ad platforms, analytics, email and CRM. None mention TV spot data, newspaper ads, billing or approvals.
- Databox only shows data in its own dashboard builder. A team that wants to keep Excel as the working file has no easy path.

- Prices count per source or per client. A brand owner with many brands and files could pay more as it grows.

Competitor intelligence tools

These tools show how to lay out rival data side by side. None of them is proven for Bangladesh, and the best ones are priced for enterprises.

Tool	What it tracks	Price signal	Limit
Pathmatics	Competitor ads, ad spend estimates, creatives, media mix, channel breakdown, history	Enterprise pricing	Steep learning curve. Some data is delayed.
Socialinsider	Competitor results across Instagram, Facebook, YouTube and X	From $99 a month (14-day trial)	Social only
Semrush	How rivals show up in organic search, paid search and search results	$0 to $499.95 a month	Light on social. Socialinsider says its tracker shows high-level numbers, not what drives them.
Meltwater	Media, social and PR intelligence across channels	Custom pricing	Not checked
Ad spy tools (AdSpy, BigSpy, PowerAdSpy, Foreplay)	Searchable libraries of Meta and other ads	About $49 to $389 a month	Engagement numbers are estimates

What to copy

- **Side-by-side benchmarks.** One chart, your brand against three rivals, same period. *Example: Savlon Soap against its three tracked rivals on share of voice for the same month.*

- **A creative gallery.** Pathmatics sells creative intelligence. A simple version for ACI is a monthly wall of rival ad screenshots with start date and platform.
- **Long-running ads as a signal.** Segwise notes that an ad still running after weeks is a better hint of performance than likes. ACI's manual Meta log can record each ad's start date.
- **A short, capped watchlist.** The same article says a bloated watchlist is the most common reason tracking dies. ACI's plan of three rivals per brand fits this.

What these tools cannot do for ACI

- I found no sign that any of them covers Bangladeshi TV, newspapers or radio. I did not check each vendor's country list.
- Their ad spend numbers are estimates, not billed amounts. ACI's own TV, Print and Radio tracking files are the better source for those channels.
- Paying for Pathmatics-level data is a business decision for later. The first version can run on ACI's uploads and a manual log.

Billing and finance tools

Accounts payable tools show how to run bill status, approvals and roles. They also show the biggest risk: a bill list that no longer matches real payments.

Tool	Strength	Price signal	Caveat
Tipalti	Invoice capture, approval workflows, role-based permissions, payment status tracking, vendor management	From $99 a month	Users complain about static aging reports. Payments made outside the tool do not sync back.
BILL	Invoice capture, approval workflows, payment scheduling, payable insights, 6 standard user roles	Free trial	Built for small and mid-sized firms
Stampli	Invoice capture and approvals. Connects to over 70 accounting systems (listing).	No free trial	Users note it has no AP aging schedule

What to copy

- **A status on every bill.** ACI's billing file already uses states such as Payment Done, Cheque in Hand, Finance/Audit and Bill Error. Show them as a coloured chip. *Example: "Cheque in Hand" is blue. "Bill Error" is red.*
- **Approval steps with roles.** Tipalti and BILL both route bills to approvers. This matches the Super Admin and Finance roles agreed for ACI.
- **An aging view.** Group unpaid bills by days waiting: 0 to 14, 15 to 29, 30 and over. These match ACI's yellow and red rules.
- **Reminders from the list.** One tap on an overdue bill sends "Remind Finance".

The risk to design against

One Tipalti user reports that payments made outside the tool do not sync back, so the aging report differs from the real one and someone must fix it by hand.

ACI will face the same problem if finance pays a bill through the bank or a cheque and nobody clicks "paid". The agreed rule "manual edits win, uploads are versioned, mismatches are flagged" is the right defence. Two additions to test in UX research:

- A weekly "check these bills" list of items unpaid for a long time that may already be paid.
- A clear "who marked this paid, and when" line on every bill.

Competitor social data: what can be pulled

Only YouTube can be pulled automatically for rivals. Meta needs a manual log, and TikTok has no fitting official route.

Platform	Rival data you can get	Route	Limit
Meta (Facebook, Instagram)	The ads a rival is running, with creative and start date	Ad Library website, checked by hand	No follow feature. No spend, impressions or CTR for commercial ads outside the EU and UK. The API returns only political ads and EU or UK ads.

Platform	Rival data you can get	Route	Limit
YouTube	Public subscribers, total views, video count and recent uploads	YouTube Data API v3 with ACI's own key	Free quota of 10,000 units a day. A full channel lookup costs about 103 units, so about 100 channels a day.
TikTok	Public profiles and videos, only through paid third-party tools	Third-party data tools	Official Research API needs an academic link and bans commercial use. Third-party tools may break platform rules.
ACI's own ads	Exact spend and results	Meta Marketing API and platform exports	Needs ACI account permissions

Meta: a simple manual routine

Segwise's guide describes a weekly routine that fits ACI's three-rivals plan:

1. Pick a short watchlist. Cap it.
2. Check each rival's Ad Library page once a week and sort by start date.
3. Save the creative.
4. Tag each ad with hook, call to action, visual style, tone and main promise.
5. Compare with ACI's own best ads.

A free page monitor such as Visualping can email an alert when a rival's page changes. It is noisy and gives no tags.

YouTube: one limit to plan for

YouTube's developer policy says stored API data must be refreshed or deleted at least every 30 days. A long history chart of rival channels may need a legal check first. A monthly snapshot that ACI types in or screenshots may be safer.

TikTok: on hold

The agreed decision is to hold TikTok until ACI has done a legal check. Until then the dashboard needs a place to log TikTok rival posts by hand, the same way as Meta.

What this means for the design

- Every competitor chart needs a source tag: **Automatic**, **Logged by hand** or **Uploaded**.
- Every competitor chart needs a **last updated** date and the name of the person who owns the update.
- ACI's own Meta, YouTube and TikTok numbers can use live links. Rival numbers cannot.

Gaps and opportunity

In the pages I read, no single tool covers all six components for a brand owner in Bangladesh. Each group of tools covers two or three.

Capability	Mediaocean Prisma	Marketing dashboards	Competitor tools	Billing tools	ACI dashboard (target)
Plan	Yes	Not seen	Not seen	Not seen	Yes
Spend across TV, Print, OOH and Digital	Yes	Digital focus	Estimates only	Not seen	Yes
Performance against goals	Partly	Yes	Not seen	Not seen	Yes
Digital data (Meta, YouTube, TikTok)	Partly	Yes	Partly	Not seen	Yes
Competitor tracking	Not seen	Not seen	Yes	Not seen	Yes
Bills, approvals, reminders	Yes	Not seen	Not seen	Yes	Yes
Local fit for Bangladesh	Unproven	Not seen	Unproven	Not seen	Built on ACI's own files
Mobile approvals	Not seen	Alerts only	Not seen	Not seen	Yes

"Not seen" means the pages I read did not mention it. The tool may still do it. Treat this table as a starting view, not a proven fact.

Where ACI can stand out

1. **All six parts in one place.** *Example: a manager opens one page and sees October budget, bills waiting and a rival's new ad.*
2. **Built on local files.** Excel in, Bangladeshi TV channels, VAT shown, Taka figures.
3. **Roles and approvals for a brand owner.** Prisma serves agencies. Billing tools serve finance teams. Neither is shaped for a team that plans, pays and compares in one place.
4. **Honest data labels.** Every number says if it is automatic, logged by hand or uploaded, and when it was last updated.

Risks to the opportunity

- **Data quality comes first.** Without clean, matched files, a beautiful dashboard shows wrong numbers. The section "What ACI's data shows" lists the problems.
- **Manual logs can go stale.** Meta rival logs and TV, Print and Radio uploads need a named owner and a reminder.
- **A cheaper test exists.** A free Looker Studio report on a clean Google Sheet could test the Plan, Spend and Performance views before ACI builds a full tool. It would not cover roles, approvals or reminders.
- **Competitor data has legal limits** for YouTube history and TikTok (see the section on social data).

Patterns to copy and to avoid

Six patterns are worth copying and four are worth avoiding. Each links back to something a tool already does.

Copy

Pattern	Seen in	How ACI uses it
One home page that answers "are we on track?"	Databox	Budget used, bills waiting and best-reach channel in the top row
Goal, target and colour alert on each number	Databox	ACI's rules: orange at 90%, red at 100%, yellow at 15 days, red at 30 days

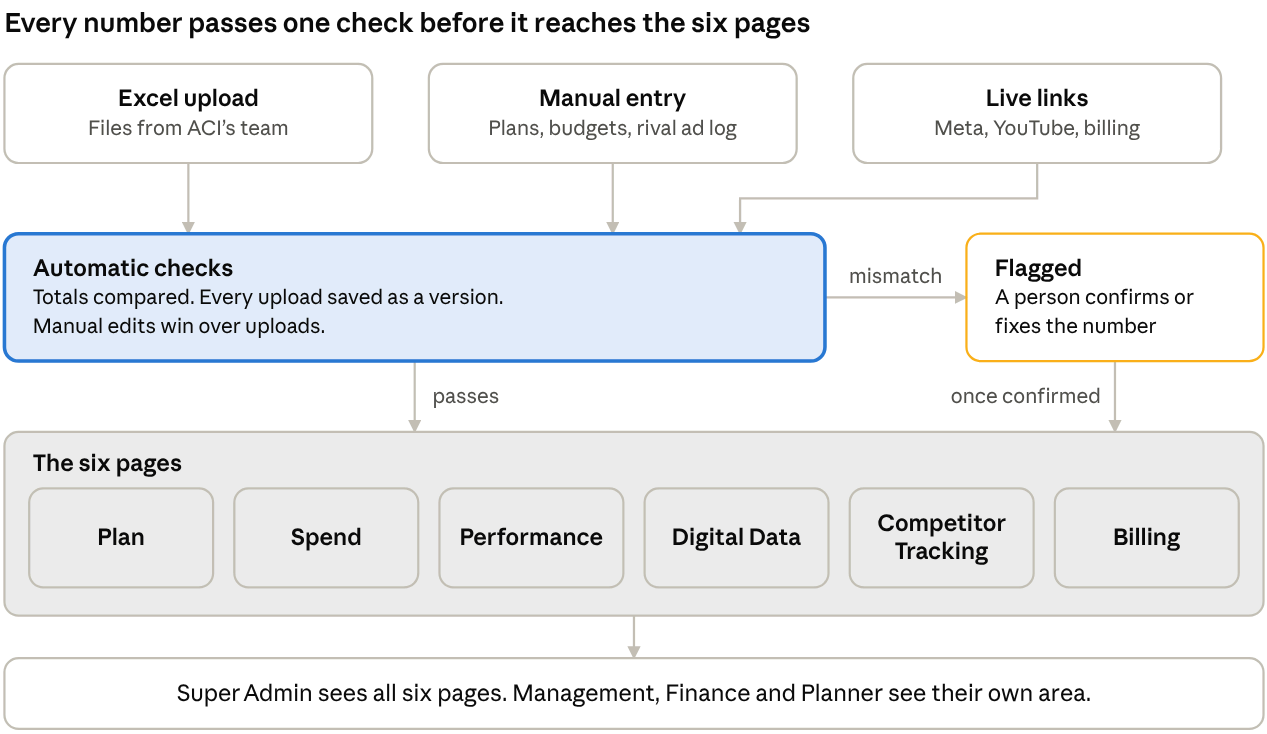
Pattern	Seen in	How ACI uses it
One system from plan to bill	Mediaocean Prisma	Plan, spend and bill sit side by side for each brand and month
Status chip and roles on every bill	Tipalti, BILL	Payment Done, Cheque in Hand, Finance/Audit and Bill Error as chips. Super Admin, Finance, Management and Planner roles.
Side-by-side rival benchmark	Socialinsider, Pathmatics	Your brand against three rivals for the same month
Weekly capped watchlist	Meta Ad Library routine	Three rivals per brand, checked on a set day

Avoid

- **Enterprise complexity.** Prisma's reviewers praise ease of use. A tool for managers and finance must feel light.
- **Reports that drift from reality.** Tipalti users report aging reports that no longer match real payments. Use history logs, weekly "check these bills" lists and clear "who marked this paid" lines.
- **A separate place to learn.** Databox keeps data in its own builder. Let ACI export to Excel, so the team never feels locked in.
- **Numbers without a source.** Pathmatics-style tools give ad spend as estimates, and reviewers note that some data arrives late. Label every figure with its source and date.

UX implications

The dashboard needs one home page that changes by role, six component pages and a shared upload-and-check flow. This is a starting proposal to test in UX research, not a final design.



data flow · 3 inputs, 1 check, 6 pages

Excel uploads, manual entry and live links all pass the same check. A mismatch goes to a person, and everything that passes feeds the six pages.

Home page by role

Role	First screen	Top three cards
Super Admin	Everything overview	Budget status by brand. Overdue bills with "Remind". Approvals waiting.
Management	Summary	Budget status. Best-reach channel. Approvals waiting.
Finance	Bills	Unpaid bills by age. Budget change requests. Payment status counts.
Planner	Plans	This month's plan against spend. Files still to upload. Channel reach.

The six component pages

Component	Main job	Key elements	Edit actions	On mobile
Plan	Build and change the monthly plan	Campaign calendar by brand and channel. Planned cost against budget.	Add or edit a plan. Request a budget change.	View and approve
Spend	See spend against plan and budget	Brand by month table. TV channel cost list. VAT label on every figure.	Upload files. Correct a number (saved in history).	Summary
Performance	Find the channel with the best reach	Cost per 1,000 people reached for each channel. TV (GRP, share of voice) and Digital numbers underneath.	Filter by brand and month	Summary
Digital Data	See ACI's own Meta, YouTube and TikTok results	Reach, impressions and cost per view by platform	Connect an account or upload	Summary
Competitor Tracking	Compare a brand with its three rivals	Side-by-side chart with source tag and last updated date. Rival ad log.	Add a Meta ad log entry. Upload TV, Print and Radio files.	View only
Billing	Show all unpaid bills in one click	Bill list with status chips and age groups. PO, bill amount, VAT.	Mark as paid. Send reminder. Add a note.	Approve and remind

Rules that apply on every screen

- **Every number carries three labels:** its source (automatic, logged by hand or uploaded), its VAT basis and its last updated date.

- **Warning colours use ACI's rules.** Bills turn yellow at 15 days and red at 30. Budgets turn orange at 90% and red at 100%. Settings let ACI change these.
- **Upload flow:** upload, automatic checks, a saved version, flagged mismatches, then a person confirms. *Example: a September file arrives with a total 0.70M higher than the report. The screen flags it and asks Finance to confirm.*
- **Empty states.** A brand with zero spend shows a clear message, not a blank chart.
- **A history log** shows who changed what and when. Super Admin can see all of it.

Open questions, risks and next steps

Nine checks remain open before UX research can rely on the data. Most need one question to one person.

Open check	Why it matters	How to close it
Who makes the TV, Print and Radio files	The dashboard needs a named owner for monthly uploads	File details show 35 of 36 files last saved under one person's name (Mizanur Rahman). This is a clue, not proof. Ask him.
September and October agency numbers	VAT cannot be confirmed for those months	Ask whoever keeps the Agency Wise Cost file to add them
VAT basis of OOH numbers	OOH is not in the agency file	Ask the same person
Which total is right: 130.66M or 129.96M	The gap of 0.70M is in the Hygiene figures	Check the Hygiene rows in the spend report
The real Savlon Baby Wipes dashboard	The file named for it is a copy of the Baby Soft dashboard	Ask for the correct file
A Salt TV, Print and Radio tracking file	Salt has 8.5M TV spend but no rival tracking	Ask whether one exists or can be made
TikTok legal check	Third-party data tools may break platform rules	Ask ACI's legal or compliance team
YouTube 30-day storage rule	It may limit long rival history charts	Same legal check

Open check	Why it matters	How to close it
Bangladesh coverage of competitor vendors	I did not test whether Pathmatics, Socialinsider or others cover local data	Ask each vendor for a country list if buying is ever considered

Next steps

1. **Close the data checks above.** Start with the owner of the tracking files and the real Baby Wipes dashboard.
2. **Collect Mobbin references.** There is no Mobbin connection in this chat. Paste screenshots or links for five screen types: dashboard home, budget against actual, invoice list with status, approval screen and notifications.
3. **Interview users.** Talk to a few people in each role (Super Admin, Management, Finance, Planner). Ask how they check budget and bills today and what they open first.
4. **Sort the scope.** Ask users to mark each of the six components "must have" or "later".
5. **Test a clickable prototype** with three tasks: check October budget for one brand, find bills unpaid for over 30 days, and compare a brand with a rival.
6. **Measure the two goals.** Count brands that stay inside budget, and time how long it takes to find all unpaid bills.

Sources

Two web pages were opened in full. The rest were read as search results only, and many are written by the tool vendors themselves, so treat their claims with care. Pages were checked on 1 November 2026.

ACI files (opened and analysed)

- Four monthly Activity Calendars (July to October 2026)
- CB Media Spent Report 2026-27 (V4, updated 27 October 2026)
- Channel Cost 26-27 (V4, updated 27 October 2026)
- Agency Wise Cost FY 26-27
- Six brand dashboards (September 2026)
- Toiletries, Hygiene and Salt digital media files

- Dashboard Media Final Fixed (26 October 2026) and Media Billing Statement (26 October 2026)
- 36 tracking reports dated July 2025 (opened for structure and file details only; the large TV files were not read in full)

Web pages opened in full

- Segwise: How to Track Competitor Ads on Meta (April 2026). Written by a tool vendor.
- PPC Land: Mediaocean's Prisma Direct (31 March 2026)

Pages read as search results only

- Media planning: Mediaocean Prisma platform, G2 Prisma reviews, G2 review summary, media planning tool directory
- Marketing dashboards: Porter Metrics: Databox alternatives, Albato: reporting tools, 1ClickReport: Looker Studio alternatives, Cometly, Supermetrics, Toolradar, AgencyAnalytics alternatives
- Competitor intelligence: Socialinsider: competitor analysis tools, Socialinsider: Semrush Social, Meltwater guide, Pathmatics against Semrush (also the source for Semrush's price range)
- Billing: Rajesh Kumar: AP tools, G2: Tipalti reviews, G2: Tipalti, BILL and Stampli, Ramp: Tipalti against BILL, FlowForma, Cashflow.io
- Social data: Apify: YouTube channel stats, Apify: YouTube channel scraper, SociaVault: TikTok API in 2026, SociaVault: TikTok data without the Research API, AdsUploader: Facebook Ad Library API